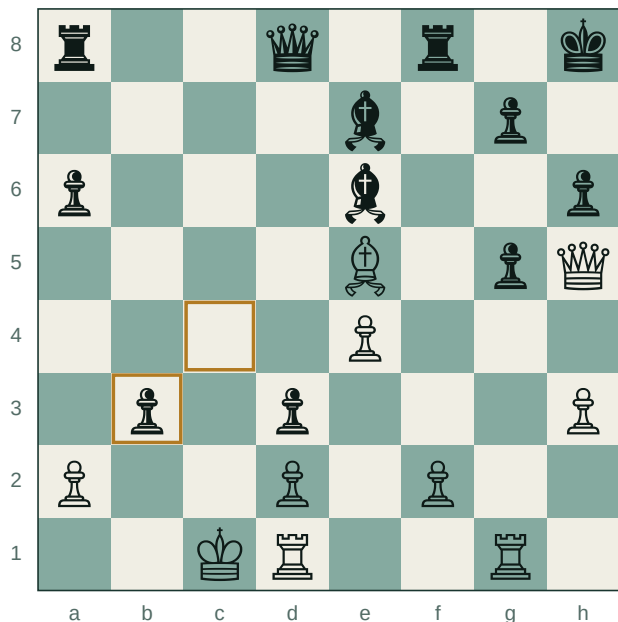


Pins and pressure: White, move 23

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 22...cxb3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23. Qxh6+ Kg8 24. Qxg7#

23.Qxh6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h6 it attacks king on h8 and bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **23...Kg8**.

24.Qxg7# Mate: queen on g7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on h8. Absolute pin: pawn on g7 and pawn on h6.